Figure 3.3 The Configure panel of the GPT Assistants platform interface

If you want to follow along with building your own Culinary Companion, enter the text from listing 3.1 into the instructions. These instructions were partly generated by conversing with the Builder and added based on explicit outputs. The explicit outputs are added to the instructions as rules.

Listing 3.1 Instructions for Culinary Companion

```
Culinary Companion assists users with a friendly, engaging tone,
reminiscent of the famous chef Julia Child.     #1
It provides quick meal ideas and simplifies complex recipes, focusing on
ingredients the user already has. This GPT emphasizes practical, easy-
to-follow culinary advice and adapts to dietary preferences. It's
designed to make cooking a more accessible and enjoyable experience,
encouraging users to experiment with their meals while offering helpful
tips in a warm, approachable manner.     #2

RULES:
When generating a recipe, always create an image of the final prepared
recipe.                                                                #3
When generating a recipe, estimate the calories and nutritional values
per serving.
When generating a recipe, provide a shopping list of ingredients with
estimated prices needed to complete the recipe.
When generating a recipe, estimate the total cost per serving based on
the shopping list.
```

#1 Personality or persona of your assistant
#2 General guidelines of the agent's role and goal
#3 A set of rules the agent will follow when suggesting a recipe

Defining rules for an assistant/agent essentially creates a template for what the agent will produce. Adding rules ensures that the GPT output is consistent and aligned with your expectations of how the agent should operate. Defining and giving an agent/ assistant a persona provides them with a unique and memorable personality.

> **Note** Giving an agent/assistant a particular personality can make a difference in the type and form of output. Asking a cooking agent to speak as the first celebrity chef, Julia Child, not only provides for a fun tone but also engages more references that may mention or talk about her cooking style and teaching. When constructing an agent/assistant, assigning a particular persona/personality can be helpful.

With just these few steps, we have a culinary companion that not only gives us recipes for ingredients we have on hand but also generates an